

Acer eMachine EL1352-H22C

Acer has announced the launch of small form factor PCs with EL1352-H22C running on a 2.7 GHz AMD Athlon II X2 215 dual core processor

2800 fps at 1080p

Vision Research's camera Phantom Flex can capture 1080p images at a whopping 2800 frames per second with a 1000 ISO sensitivity

Desktop PC test

APPLE IMAC 27 INCH

Apple does it again. With its 27 inch iMac, Apple has set new standards yet again, in terms of screen resolution. At a massive 2560 x 1440 pixel, this is probably the only all-in-one with that kind of resolution. The screen comes with an expensive IPS panel with LED backlighting. Thus the contrast ratio is very high and the output is highly luminescent. It has a very high pixel density of 109 pixels per inch, which is higher than the 30-inch Cinema Display screen, thus making the text and images on the screen appear very crisp. It has an aspect ratio of 16:9 and despite the large size, the viewing angle at 178 degrees is quite good. It will definitely take some time getting used to the large screen size.

This iteration of the iMac is powered by an Intel Core 2 Duo E7600 running at 3.06 GHz. It comes with 4 GB of DDR3 RAM with an ATI Radeon HD5670 graphics card. It can run games smoothly at HD resolutions of 1920 x 1080, but don't expect exceptional frame rates at the full 2560 x 1440 pixel resolution.

The traditional black and silver-gray colour combination is followed along with the aluminium build which is very sturdy. The screen is surrounded by a black glossy bezel which is quite reflective. The speakers are housed on the bottom edge of the screen. All the port connections are present on the rear side of the iMac screen. There are four USB ports, one mini DisplayPort, one

FireWire 800 port, one LAN port and the audio jacks. It's very annoying of Apple to place audio jacks on the back of a PC. A power button is merged with the chassis on the left bottom edge, and is easily missed. On the right edge you will find the optical drive and an SD card slot. Sadly the iMac does not sport a Blu ray drive, but it does come with 1 TB of HDD storage.

The keyboard is equally disappointing. The keyboard is bluetooth enabled, with an extremely slim body. This compact sized keyboard has been



achieved at the cost of the number pad. buttons like Page Up, Page Down, etc. The keyboard is somewhat uncomfortable to use, due to its ridiculously small form factor.

The wireless magic mouse on the other hand is an innovative accessory that has support for multi-touch gestures. Running your fingers down its length executes a scrolling action, this explains the missing Page Up and Page down buttons; by moving fingers sideways on the mouse, you execute the next/previous commands. The two black plastic fins present under the mouse, make operating the mouse somewhat sluggish. Either ways, navigating the huge screen from end to end with this tiny mouse, will require some getting used to.

This is one lifestyle product aimed at professionals. At the same time, the ease of setting up the system and getting started with using it leaves one thoroughly impressed. Startup time is as quick as 25 seconds. It just has one power connection as the keyboard

and the mouse is Bluetooth-enabled. It comes pre-installed with Mac OS X version 10.6.2 with inbuilt applications such as Aperture, iMovie, Final Cut Pro, Garage Band, etc. This is good for professionals who work on specialised software. The large screen size allows you to divide the screen into a workbench and output sections easily.

We ran a couple of benchmarks like Xbench and Geekbench, and also real world tests. Xbench gave a score of 176, while GeekBench gave an overall score of 4214, which is 200 points higher than the iMac 24-inch with an Intel core 2 Duo E8435 @ 3.06GHz. Real life tests like data transfer took 81 seconds for a 4 GB sequential file transfer, and 91 seconds for a 4 GB assorted file transfer.

Keeping in line with the Apple tradition the iMac 27 inch comes at a hefty price tag of Rs. 89,900 which is understandable considering this the only desktop in the market with such a huge screen and build quality is also absolutely top notch - this is a quality product. It's practical and powerful.

121 frames per second for Doom 3. The HP Pavillion 6373in will set you back by Rs. 47,990 which we feel is a bit expensive considering you only get an 18.5 inch monitor along with it. In terms of performance its only marginally higher than the Lenovo B500, but it's priced at Rs. 10,000 more. **d**

DIGIT RECOMMENDS

We decided from the outset that we would not award any winners this month due to the limited number of products. Also the products spanned various categories: from normal PCs and all-in-ones to a nettop. We decided to give you the scores based on the performance and features so that based on your usage scenarios, you can decide for yourself which PC is ideally suited for your needs.

In terms of performance, we found that the HP Pavillion p6373in was ahead of everyone, but only marginally ahead

of the all-in-one Lenovo B500. At the same time its price was also the highest. Among the Acer PCs, the performance purely depended on the processor as all the other accessories were the same.

We'd recommend any of the Acer PCs to those looking for an entry-level PC that does decent graphics. For those looking at high-end graphics, the p6373in and B500 are both very close. If price is the deciding factor then B500 is ideally suited as it is around Rs.10,000 cheaper than the HP.